



Chip design

Chip design as a career option? Yes, we are talking about building the hearts of almost all the devices that surround us. In IT-parlance, the chip is the wafer-thin slice of silicon that forms the base for an integrated circuit. Producing it isn't all that simple. In fact, it is a highly complex task that can broadly be divided into three phases: design, fabrication and assembly. The return is to watch the world around you use your product to run its life.

● Why bother?

Gartner estimates that the market will grow by 26 per cent in 2008, year-on-year. Between 2007 and 2012, we expect the third-party chip design services market in India to grow at a CAGR of about 22.3 per cent, to reach nearly \$830 million by 2012.

● How do I progress faster in this profession?

Constant improvement of skills and knowledge is a must as the design tools and processes keep evolving.